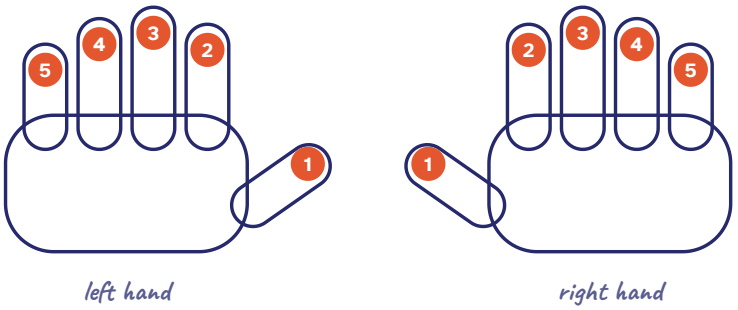
PART VIII · PLAYING AND LISTENING · 1

# Fingering

Each finger has a number, the same in both hands: the thumb is 1, the little finger 5. Good fingering is planned, not guessed: choose it once, write it in, and use it every time.

**THE SECRET**

**Thumbs are 1 in both hands. Choose a fingering once, write it in, keep it.**




*Thumbs are 1 in both hands*

## Five-finger position




Thumb on C, one finger on each key up to G: five notes without moving the hand. Many first pieces stay in one position.

## Thumb under, finger over




Up the scale: 1 2 3, thumb under to F, then 1 2 3 4 5.




Down: 5 4 3 2 1, then 3 crosses over the thumb.

**TWO-MINUTE DRILL** Play C D E F G with each hand, saying the finger numbers: right 1 2 3 4 5 up, left 5 4 3 2 1 up. Then both hands together.

**Left hand, C major up:** 5 4 3 2 1, then 3 crosses over to A, then 2 1. **Down:** 1 2 3, thumb under to F, then 1 2 3 4 5.

PART VIII · PLAYING AND LISTENING · 1 · CONTINUED

EXAMPLE 1

**Which finger plays the F?**




?

1. **C D E** are 1 2 3.
2. **The F:** finger 4, or the thumb tucked under?
3. **Then** how do you reach the top C?

The **thumb** passes under to F; then 2 3 4 5 reach the top C.

EXAMPLE 2

**Which finger plays G?**

**Right hand, thumb on C** ?

1. **Thumb on C** is 1.
2. **Count up** one finger per key: D, E, F, G.
3. **So G** is…?

Finger **5**: C D E F G is 1 2 3 4 5.

GAME

**Name the finger**

| | |
|---|---|
| 1 thumb | 2 index |
| 3 middle | 4 little |

Give the finger number.

Answer: 1 one · 2 two · 3 three · 4 five.

TRY IT · 10 SECONDS




**Five fingers, five keys.**

Right hand on C D E F G. Play up and down, saying the finger numbers aloud. Then the left hand: 5 4 3 2 1 from C up.

TRAP

- × Changing fingering every time you play: choose one, write it in, keep it.
- × Landing heavily on the thumb as it passes under: let it glide.

SEE ALSO

The keyboard p. 22 · Major scales p. 89

PRACTISE IT

Online: Scales with fingering